

YOUR RETIREMENT INSIGHTS

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THE TRIPLE LOCK IS CHANGING

What the proposed shake-up to the state pension really means, when it happens, and the practical questions worth asking about your own retirement now.

WHAT'S JUST BEEN ANNOUNCED

After years of political guarantees, the state pension "triple lock" is now set to change.

At the Labour Party conference in September 2026, Andy Burnham announced plans to **scrap the pensions triple lock**. In its place would come a "double lock": from around **2030**, the state pension would rise by **inflation or 2.5%, whichever is higher** - with the link to average earnings removed. The savings are earmarked to help fund a new National Care Service.

Important context: this is a proposed policy direction, not yet law, and it is being debated even within government. Nothing changes to your state pension immediately - the current triple lock is expected to remain until the end of this Parliament, with any change taking effect from around 2030.

SO WHY DOES IT MATTER NOW?

Because the decisions that protect your retirement income are made years in advance, not in the year a change lands. If the state pension is going to do less of the heavy lifting in future, the part you control - your private and workplace pensions, your timing, and your tax planning - matters more than ever.

This guide explains what is actually changing, who it affects most, and the questions worth asking today.

TRIPLE LOCK VS DOUBLE LOCK

The **triple lock** has guaranteed that the state pension rises each year by the highest of three measures. The proposed **double lock** removes one of them - the earnings link.

MEASURE	TRIPLE LOCK (NOW)	DOUBLE LOCK (PROPOSED, ~2030)
Average earnings growth	Included	Removed
Inflation (CPI)	Included	Included
2.5% floor	Included	Included

In plain terms: your state pension would still rise by **inflation or 2.5%, whichever is higher**. But in years when wages grow faster than both, you would no longer get that higher, earnings-linked increase.

WHY THE EARNINGS LINK MATTERS

Over the last decade, average earnings have frequently outpaced inflation. In those years, the earnings link delivered the biggest state pension increases. Removing it means that, over a full retirement, the state pension could grow more slowly than it would have - and end up worth less in real terms than today's rules would deliver.

The exact impact depends on how wages, inflation and 2.5% compare in each future year - which is why it is worth understanding the direction of travel rather than waiting for a single headline number.

WHERE YOU SIT CHANGES EVERYTHING

ALREADY RETIRED / RETIRING BEFORE ~2030

You are largely protected in the near term - the triple lock is expected to hold until the change takes effect. The bigger question is how resilient your income is for the decades *after* 2030, when uprating may be lower.

10-15 YEARS FROM RETIREMENT (ROUGHLY 50-60)

This is the group most affected. You will likely retire into the new system, and you still have time to adjust what you control - contributions, investment strategy, and when and how you draw income.

YOUNGER SAVERS

The state pension may form a smaller share of your retirement than you'd assume today. The habit that matters most is simple: contribute earlier and consistently to the pensions you control.

Whatever your age, the takeaway is the same: **lean less on assumptions about the state pension, and more on a plan you control.**

5 LEVERS THAT MATTER MORE NOW

You can't control government policy. You can control these.

1 YOUR CONTRIBUTIONS

If the state pension does less, your private and workplace pensions do more. Even small increases, especially with employer matching and tax relief, compound significantly over 10-20 years.

2 TAX ALLOWANCES & WRAPPERS

Pensions, ISAs and allowances all interact. Using the right wrapper in the right order can meaningfully change how much of your money you keep in retirement.

3 WHEN YOU ACCESS YOUR PENSIONS

The age and order in which you draw from different pots affects tax, longevity of the fund, and how exposed you are to any single income source.

4 HOW YOUR MONEY IS INVESTED

The right level of risk and structure for your stage of life influences whether your income keeps pace with rising costs across a long retirement.

5 SEQUENCING & INCOME MIX

Blending guaranteed income, flexible drawdown and other assets can reduce reliance on any one lever - including the state pension.

WHEN TO START & WHAT TO AVOID

WHEN TO START PLANNING

YEARS TO RETIREMENT	FOCUS
15+ years	Maximise contributions and let time and tax relief compound.
10 years	Stress-test your plan against lower state pension growth; check the mix.
5 years	Firm up income strategy, tax position and access order.
At / in retirement	Protect against inflation and sequencing risk across a long retirement.

COMMON MISTAKES

- **Assuming nothing changes.** Planning on today's state pension rules for a retirement that runs decades past 2030.
- **Waiting for certainty.** The best planning window is before a change lands, not after.
- **Over-relying on the state pension.** Treating it as the foundation rather than one part of a broader plan.
- **Leaving pots un-reviewed.** Old workplace pensions left on default settings for years.

A SIMPLE CHECKLIST

- ✓ Know roughly what state pension you're on track for (check your forecast at gov.uk).
- ✓ Add up the pensions you control - workplace and private - in one place.
- ✓ Check whether your contributions still match the retirement you want.
- ✓ Understand how and when you'd draw income, and the tax that comes with it.
- ✓ Review how your pots are invested for your stage of life.
- ✓ Get a second opinion before any change lands, not after.

WANT THIS REVIEWED FOR YOUR SITUATION?

Your Retirement Insights can arrange a no-obligation conversation with a regulated financial adviser who can look at your circumstances and what the changes could mean for you. Reply to the email that delivered this guide, and we'll take it from there.

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

This guide is general educational information only and does not constitute financial, tax or investment advice, or a personal recommendation. Pension and tax rules are complex, subject to change, and depend on your individual circumstances. The policy changes described are proposed and had not become law at the time of writing. You should not take, or refrain from taking, any action based solely on this guide. Before making decisions, seek advice from a suitably qualified, FCA-regulated financial adviser. Your Retirement Insights is a trading style operated by ADSorbed Ltd and introduces individuals to regulated advisers; it does not itself provide regulated financial advice.